VICTORIA UNIVERSITY OF WELLINGTON TE HERENGA WAKA

WELLINGTON SCHOOL OF BUSINESS AND GOVERNMENT | ŌRAUARIKI

2026 WSBG Doctoral Colloquium

Programme · Friday 30 October 2026

Abstracts online
tinyurl.com/wsbgdc2026

TIME	SESSION	ROOM	CHAIR / HOST
8:30–9:00	Registration	**RH1201**	
9:00–9:30	**Welcome and opening remarks** Welcome and housekeeping: Associate Professor Geoff Plimmer, Associate Dean of Research, Wellington School of Business and Government Opening remarks: Professor Lisa Marriott, Dean, Faculty of Graduate Research	**RH1210**	Geoff Plimmer
9:30–10:15	**Plenary 1: Keynote** *Rigour, Relevance and Relationships* by Dr John McDermott, Executive Director, Motu Economic and Public Policy Research	**RH1210**	Martien Lubberink
10:15–10:45	**Plenary 2** *Publishing Papers from Your Thesis* by Associate Professor Geoff Plimmer	**RH1210**	Mary Tate
10:45–11:00	Morning tea	**RH1201**	

11:00–12:30 Parallel paper presentations: morning sessions

M1 — RH204

Climate Transition, Disclosure and Financial Consequences
1. Van Nguyen Thi (SEF)
2. Mariam Girgis (SACL)
3. Tangtai Liang (SMIB)

Chair: Bob Buckle
Faculty: Tiong Goh

M2 — RHMZ01

Gender, Identity and Social Influence
1. Verena Habrich (SoM)
2. Jinxin Zhu (SEF)
3. Mohamed Abdelmohsen Mohamed Desoky (SMIB)

Chair: Maja Krtalić
Faculty: Erin Roxburgh

M3 — RH207

Strategic Corporate Decisions, Markets and Uncertainty
1. Maldeniye Koralalage Chamika Hashani (SEF)
2. Athalia Hidayat (SACL)
3. Erick Mmbando (SMIB)

Chair: Janet Davey
Faculty: Yao Yao

M4 — RHMZ02

Health, Care and Sustainable Wellbeing
1. Vy Ngo (SoM)
2. Noel B. Del Castillo (SEF)
3. Natvadee Anatamsombut (SMIB)

Chair: Eric Ulm
Faculty: Isabella Li

12:30–13:30	Lunch	**RHMZ54 Foyer**	

13:30–15:00 Parallel paper presentations: afternoon sessions

A1 — RH204

AI, Interpretation and Research Governance
1. Wei Cai (SIM)
2. Jiaye He (SoM)
3. Xiliaili Yaolebasi (SEF)

Chair: Nick Ashill
Faculty: Mohammad Saud Khan

A2 — RHMZ01

Legitimacy, Institutions and Accountability
1. Regina Yan (SMIB)
2. Stephen Liu (SIM)
3. Susie Hawthorne (SoM)

Chair: Micael-Lee Johnstone
Faculty: Jan Feld

A3 — RH207

Families, Networks and Disaster Recovery
1. Quanfu Zhang (SEF)
2. Simin Yin (SIM)
3. Jadzil Baihaqi (SACL)

Chair: Todd Bridgman
Faculty: Samina Munir

A4 — RHMZ02

Learning, Development and Human Capability
1. Shanshan Liu (SMIB)
2. Oshone Momoh (SIM)
3. Ryan Meachen (SoM)

Chair: Vladimir Petkov
Faculty: Janet Toland

15:00–15:30	Afternoon tea	**RHMZ54 Foyer**	
15:30–16:15	**Student-led workshop** *The life-changing magic of writing it up: Tips and tricks for writing your thesis manuscript* by Lacy Jeffreys	**RHMZ01**	
16:15–16:30	**Awards and recognitions**	**RHMZ02**	Mary Tate
16:30–16:45	**Acknowledgements and closing remarks**	**RHMZ02**	Martien Lubberink
16:45–18:00	Drinks and nibbles	**RHMZ54 Foyer**	

Paper presentations

Each paper has about 30 minutes: 15 for the presentation, 5 for the discussant and 10 for discussion. Where no discussant is named, the presenters in the session act as group discussants for one another's papers. Abstracts, discussants and the full guide to the roles are online at tinyurl.com/wsbgdc2026.

M1: Climate Transition, Disclosure and Financial Consequences

11:00–12:30 · RH204 · Chair: Bob Buckle

1.	Van Nguyen Thi (SEF)	Mandatory climate-related disclosure regulation and firms' cost of equity capital: International evidence
2.	Mariam Girgis (SACL)	Costly Signals, Operational Silence: Transition Plan Credibility and Emissions in NZBA Banks
3.	Tangtai Liang (SMIB)	How Regulatory Pressures Shape Environmental Performance of MNEs in Carbon Intensive Industries: The Moderating Roles of Normative Pressures, Cognitive Pressures, and Green Innovation

M2: Gender, Identity and Social Influence

11:00–12:30 · RHMZ01 · Chair: Maja Krtalić

1.	Verena Habrich (SoM)	Investigating the Intersection of Power Enactment, Leadership, and Gender Inclusion
2.	Jinxin Zhu (SEF)	Fertility and Gendered Structural Transformation
3.	Mohamed Abdelmohsen Mohamed Desoky (SMIB)	The use of legal performance-enhancing supplements by young adult male non-professional gym users: A social marketing challenge

M3: Strategic Corporate Decisions, Markets and Uncertainty

11:00–12:30 · RH207 · Chair: Janet Davey

1.	Maldeniye Koralalage Chamika Hashani (SEF)	Valuation of an Irreversible Investment under Markov Regime Switching
2.	Athalia Hidayat (SACL)	Long-run Accounting Performance of Divestments and Its Association with Investors' Perceptions of Market Returns
3.	Erick Mmbando (SMIB)	Business lawfare: A conceptual framework for understanding the strategic use of legal systems in market competition

M4: Health, Care and Sustainable Wellbeing

11:00–12:30 · RHMZ02 · Chair: Eric Ulm

1.	Vy Ngo (SoM)	Rethinking Job Crafting in Demanding Frontline Roles
2.	Noel B. Del Castillo (SEF)	Causal effects of extreme weather events on mental health service use among older adults
3.	Natvadee Anatamsombut (SMIB)	Marketing system's perspective on ugly food production and consumption

A1: AI, Interpretation and Research Governance

13:30–15:00 · RH204 · Chair: Nick Ashill

1.	Wei Cai (SIM)	Toward Interpretable Spam Detection: A Structured Error Interpretation Framework for Spam Detection Based on Speech Act Theory and Small Language Models
2.	Jiaye He (SoM)	Dividing Labour, Decision Authority, and Accountability with Generative AI: Chinese International Postgraduate Researchers' First Formal Research Papers
3.	Xiliaili Yaolebasi (SEF)	The White Spaces of Science: Mapping the Design Space of Female-Teacher Effects

A2: Legitimacy, Institutions and Accountability

13:30–15:00 · RHMZ01 · Chair: Micael-Lee Johnstone

1.	Regina Yan (SMIB)	How ESG Signals Facilitate Cross-Border Mergers and Acquisitions: The Mediating Role of Host-Country Legitimacy and the Moderating Role of Geopolitical Distance
2.	Stephen Liu (SIM)	From Formal Affiliation to Relationship Development: An Institutional Work Perspective on Policy-Shaped Digital Ecosystems
3.	Susie Hawthorne (SoM)	"That's Textbook": A Case Study of the Construction and Legitimation of Worker Participation in Introductory Management Textbooks

A3: Families, Networks and Disaster Recovery

13:30–15:00 · RH207 · Chair: Todd Bridgman

1.	Quanfu Zhang (SEF)	Reconstructing Families in Linked Administrative Data: The Family Engine and an Application to Post-Earthquake Labour Adjustment
2.	Simin Yin (SIM)	Organising Chinese Immigrant Genealogical Sources and Family Networks through Information behaviour and Knowledge Graph
3.	Jadzil Baihaqi (SACL)	Accountability of Religious Non-Government Organisations: Waqf Entities in Indonesia

A4: Learning, Development and Human Capability

13:30–15:00 · RHMZ02 · Chair: Vladimir Petkov

1.	Shanshan Liu (SMIB)	Environmental Institutional Distance and the Environmental Performance of Foreign Subsidiaries in China: The Moderating Roles of Headquarters TMT Cognitive Diversity and Subsidiary CEO Experience
2.	Oshone Momoh (SIM)	AI context transformation : Addressing undergraduates learning gaps in informal self directed study
3.	Ryan Meachen (SoM)	Ideal-Self-Actualization: Toward Fulfilling the Conceptual and Empirical Potential of Self-Actualization

Student-Led Workshop

15:30–16:15 · RHMZ01

	Lacy Jeffreys (SoM)	The life-changing magic of writing it up: Tips and tricks for writing your thesis manuscript